DEVON THIELE

The Thiele Machine

THE SHAPE

A word on what I actually do, because it runs under everything after it. I do not write code or math by hand. I do not pick constants. I do not grind through derivations. I have never written a line of code on paper or in a notepad in my life. What I do is see, and direct, and refuse. When I take hold of an idea it does not stay a point. It opens up. It becomes a shape I can blow up and turn over and take apart, lay across another shape to find where the two of them touch, run forward and then back to where it started, zoom into until it is the only thing in the world and pull back until it is one dot in a field of other dots, and the whole time it stays wired to everything I have ever connected it to, the right connections and the wrong ones both, all of them live at once. I am not reading that field neutrally, the way a search would. The thing doing the looking is me, the whole of me, my gut and my mood and my stubbornness picking what lights up and which way I move through it, and that is the part you cannot lift out without turning me back into a search engine. So I see where a thing has to fit, the shape it is obligated to have, usually well before I could write it down in a single symbol. Then the model gives me the symbols, the proof checker takes them or throws them back, and I refuse anything that will not compile or does not match the shape I am holding. That refusal is the one thing in this entire document that is mine and only mine: the demand that it be true, and the throwing-out of everything that wasn't.

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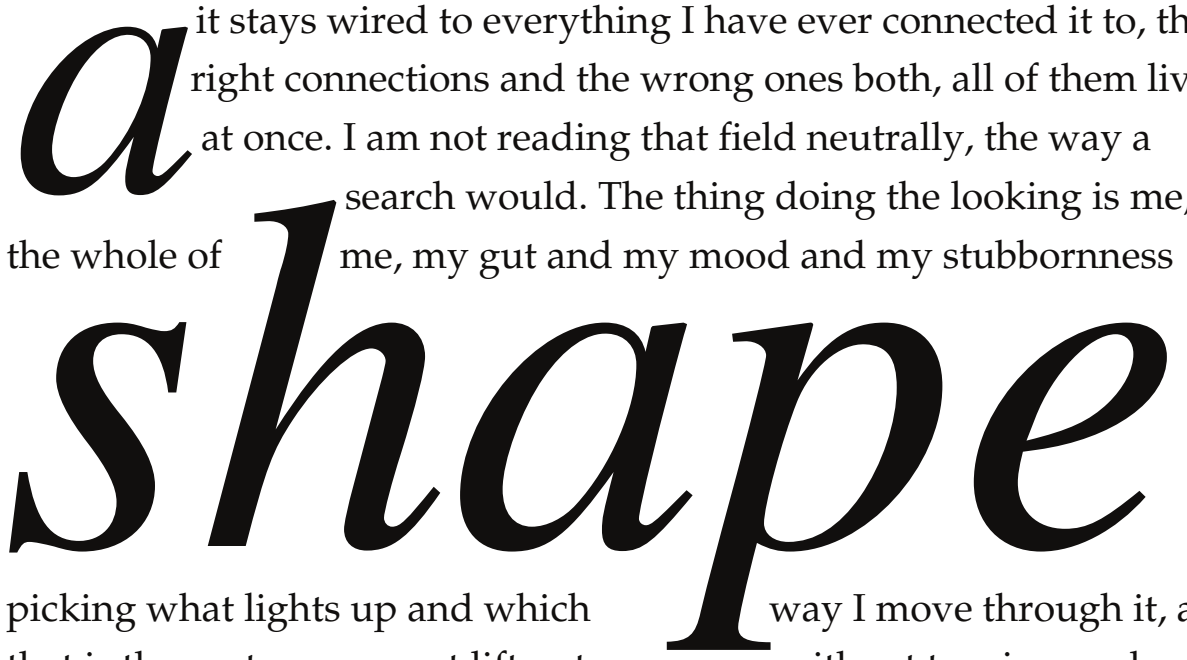
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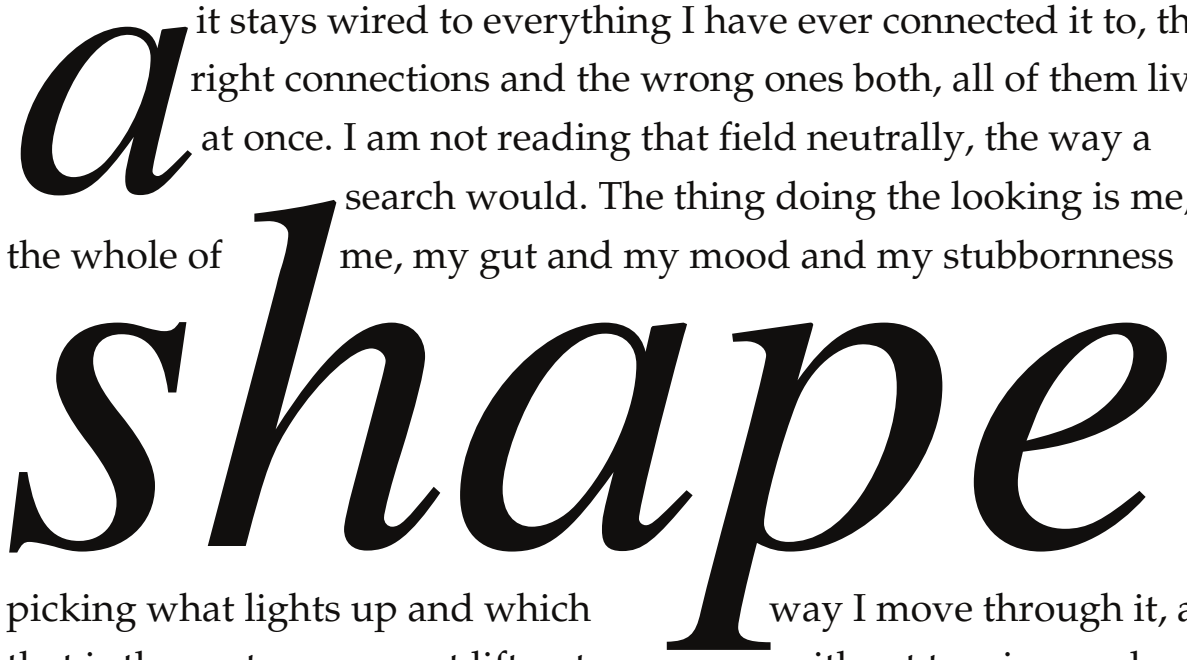
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Now there’s you.

The shape

A passage from “How I got here” supplies every word of fifteen settings. Each setting contains all 314 words, including punctuation, exactly once. The words that describe an operation undergo it. In one setting, the large word “me,” is read from the space it leaves in the surrounding text.

Enlargement, compression, inversion, separation, crossing, proximity, order, and refusal change the reading. The first and last settings of the passage are identical. The source text has not been rewritten.

This is a reading experiment for the monograph, not its new edition. Small text, changed orientation, and one crossing of text are deliberate parts of the sequence. The entire passage is readable in ordinary setting at both ends.

The same page sequence is used on screen and on ordinary opaque paper. No animation or special manufacture completes it. Print at actual size, double-sided on the long edge; the PDF page is 190.5 × 254 mm.

Text and work: Devon Thiele. Source: v4.0.0, monograph/monograph.tex, “How I got here”; the final sentence is from “Conclusion”. CC-BY-SA-4.0. URW fonts are embedded. October 2026.

The Thiele Machine

Devon Thiele